

HISTORY HACK • DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.41 — Analyze the causes of the Great Depression, including: • Bank failures • Laissez-faire politics • Buying on margin • Overextension of credit • Crash of the stock market • Overproduction in agriculture • Excess consumerism in manufacturing • High tariffs • Rising unemployment

US.42 — Explain the causes of the Dust Bowl, and its social, geographic, and economic impacts.

US.43 — Describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hoovervilles.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge.

The sources

Document A

Herbert Hoover, Press Statement on the Economy, October 25, 1929 (National Archives, public domain)

“The fundamental business of the country — that is, production and distribution of commodities — is on a sound and prosperous basis...I have no fear of the fundamental strength of our business and economic structure.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

Franklin D. Roosevelt, First Inaugural Address, March 4, 1933 (National Archives, public domain)

“The money changers have fled from their high seats in the temple of our civilization. We may now restore that temple to the ancient truths. The measure of the restoration lies in the extent to which we apply social values more noble than mere monetary profit...Happiness lies not in the mere possession of money; it lies in the joy of achievement, in the thrill of creative effort. The joy and moral stimulation of work no longer must be forgotten in the mad chase of evanescent profits.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document C

Senate Finance Committee testimony of Marriner Eccles (Federal Reserve Chairman nominee), February 5, 1935 (Congressional Record, public domain)

“Mass production has to be accompanied by mass consumption...As long as we continue to render the masses of people increasingly impotent economically, we shall not be able to bring about recovery. We must find ways of increasing their purchasing power.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT C

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of the Great Depression (1929–1941), construct an argument that answers the following question: How did competing diagnoses of the Great Depression's causes reflect fundamentally different visions of the government's proper role in the economy? In your response, you **MUST**: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view)

1. at least one HIPP element per document. 2. Identify the different diagnoses of the Depression offered by each document and connect them to the speaker's broader ideological position. 3. Construct a central argument that uses evidence from all three documents **AND** at least two pieces of outside historical knowledge to explain how these competing diagnoses shaped the policy debate of the 1930s. 4. Evaluate which diagnosis
2. Hoover's, FDR's, or Eccles's
3. most accurately accounted for the structural causes of the Depression and explain why

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Document C		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

